



By Half Term

One sheet, filled in during form time in the first week of a half term and turned over and finished in the last one. A student writes one thing they want to be true by half term, checks that it is theirs to do rather than somebody else's decision, and names the three things it depends on. One sheet each, printed back to back, and nothing to prepare. What it asks for is follow-through rather than ambition, which is why the second side is the important one.

Before you start. Keep the goals off the wall and out of the register. A form where everybody's goal is public turns into a form where everybody writes a safe one, and the students who most need the last week of it are the ones who will not put a real answer on a display.

Print these

Page	What it is
Page 2	Week one. One each, printed on the front.
Page 3	The last week. Print it on the back of page 2 so the two halves cannot get separated.

How it works

Step	What happens
Before	Print the two pages back to back. Collect them in at the end of the first week and keep them somewhere you will find them again in seven weeks, or the second half of this never happens.
1	Five minutes in the first week of the half term. They fill in the front. Question 2 is the one worth reading out and explaining before they start.
2	Hand them back in the last week and give them five minutes on the back. Tell them to read the front before they write anything.
3	Question 3 on the back is the one that teaches something. Most students predict the wrong obstacle, and noticing that is worth more than the goal was.
4	They keep the sheet. If you are doing it again next half term, the new front page starts from what they wrote in question 4.

Worth knowing

- Question 2 is the whole resource. A goal that depends on a teacher, a selection or a result is a wish, and rewriting it as the part they control is the move most of them have never been taught.
- Expect a first attempt along the lines of getting better at maths. Ask what somebody watching them would see them doing differently, and let them write that instead.
- The smallest version in question 4 is what carries a bad week. If they cannot name one, the goal is too big to survive a half term.
- It sits well next to Today I Will, which does the same job for a single day. A form that has done one takes about half the time over the other.

Collect them in, put a note in your diary for the last week, and hand them back.





Week one

One thing you want to be true by half term, and the three things it is going to depend on. Nobody is marking this and nobody is collecting it in.

NAME

HALF TERM BEGINNING

1 By half term I will

2 Is this yours to do?

If it depends on somebody else deciding something, a grade, a place in a team, a part in a play, then it is not yet a thing you can keep.

Write it again as the part that is down to you, and only that part. Then the rest of this sheet is worth filling in.

3 What it depends on

DO MOST WEEKS

STOP DOING

NEED, OR NEED FROM SOMEBODY

4 The first thing, this week

5 If a week goes badly, the smallest version of this is

WHO IS GOING TO ASK ME ABOUT IT

WHEN





The last week

Turn the sheet over and read what you wrote in the first week before you answer any of this.

NAME

TODAY'S DATE

1 Copy across what you wrote in week one

2 What actually happened

3 What got in the way

Was it the thing you said it would depend on? ☐ Yes ☐ No

4 So, for the next half term

Tick one. Dropping something you have stopped caring about is a decision, not a failure.

☐
Keep it

☐
Change it

☐
Drop it

5 By the end of term I will

6 What would you tell somebody who is about to fill in the front of this sheet?

A half term is seven weeks. Almost nobody gets seven good ones in a row, and the people who finish things are not the people who never had a bad week.